

Cambridge Harkener

Celebrating the Heritage of Cambridge and Jeffersonville Vermont

Cambridge, Vermont

Vol. I, No. 1

Summer 2001

Officers

<i>President:</i>	Adam Howard	644-2040
<i>Vice President:</i>	Roberta Marsh	644-2678
<i>Secretary:</i>	Marc Mallett	644-8882
<i>Co-Secretary:</i>	Julie Twombly Brown	644-1916
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<i>Honorary Directors:</i>	Harold Putnam, Wendell Wells	



The Warner Lodge Building, on the right, in its original location next to the Melvin Store

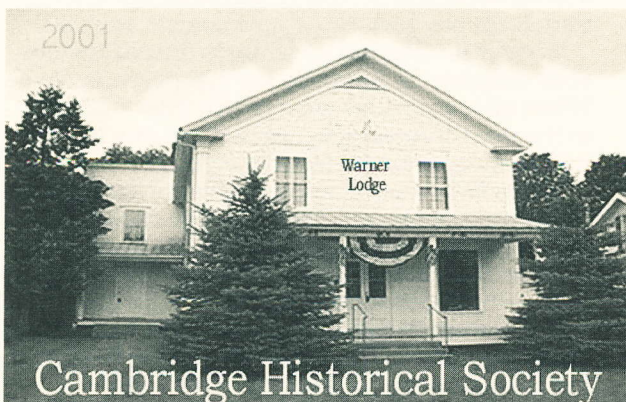
A Short History of the Warner Lodge Building

Warner Lodge #50 was chartered on January 12, 1860. Circa 1866 the lodge purchased the building now known as the Warner Lodge Building from Mr. W. Griswold for \$275.00. At that time the building stood next to the Melvin Store at the head of Main Street. Originally, the lodge leased the 2nd floor to the Good Templers, a religious sect, but in 1900 the members voted not to renew this lease. In that same year, a local Order of the Eastern Star lodge began meeting on the first floor of the building.

In 1911, Mr. Melvin offered to trade the land on which the lodge building was situated for a like parcel on School Street. The building was thus moved to its current location. On March 23, 1911, ceremonies were held as the building was placed on its new foundation. Over the years, the building was enlarged and remodeled, until it reached its current proportions.

The Cambridge Historical Society, after reforming in 1999 began looking for a permanent meeting place, and eventually decided to purchase the Warner Lodge Building to act as the Society's headquarters. On November 1, 2000 the building and property were purchased for \$55,000.00 and the process of updating and renovating the building began.

—Compiled from information supplied by Wendell Wells



The Warner Lodge Building in its new location and incarnation, as the Society's headquarters

In this issue

A Short History of the Warner Lodge Building
Reports:

President
Treasurer
Building Committee
Cemetery Committee

Exhibition 2001

Save Your Family History, Part I

Farewell Tribute to Malcolm and Sally Bevins

Birthday Tribute to Wendell 'Stub' Wells

Forthcoming Events and Meeting Notes

Officer and Committee Reports

President's Report

Dear Members,

Though many members were gone south the Historical Society enjoyed a modicum of activity through the exceptionally snowy winter. Still, the numbers who turned out at the monthly meetings, despite the snow, were a great indicator of the continued enthusiasm for the Warner Lodge and the other work we've undertaken.

We did an incredible amount of work last year, and now that we have a building to take care of we have a lot more work ahead of us. As you'll read in the reports throughout this newsletter work is underway to get the Lodge up to code and outline the future needs of the Historical Society as it pertains to the building. The Building Committee has been working with an architect to establish a plan that will include everything from updating the electrical system to thinking of office space and perhaps someday an addition.

Things have really picked up again, and committees are hard at work doing their thing. The monthly meetings are much less about business and more about programming and presentations, which is as it should be thanks to Carol Bacon and the Program Committee. Please join us at the next meeting. Thanks for your continued support and time.

—Adam Howard

Treasurer's Report

The current membership for the Cambridge Historical Society is 111 for the year 2001. Thirty six of these are Life Members and the remainder are either Family or Individual Members. We are very lucky to have members not only from all over Vermont but from Massachusetts, Maryland, Alaska, California, Illinois, Michigan, Florida and Rhode Island.

Our membership is a bargain with an individual being able to join for \$10, a family for \$15, a business for \$25 and a Life Membership is only \$100. If you have not already renewed your membership, please do so. Not only will you continue to receive our Newsletter, but you will also be a welcome participant in all our future meetings and events!

—Linda Ward

Building Committee Report

The Building Committee has put a lot of effort into locating money to fund our building projects. We have been awarded 2 grants: one from the Preservation Trust of Vermont for \$25,000, funded by the Freeman Foundation and one from Vermont Arts Council for \$3,139. We were able to secure funding from both the town (\$10,000) and the state (\$20,000 thanks to State Representative Rick Westman). All this makes \$58,139 available for our projects. Our goal was \$70,000, so there will be a need to generate more money this summer through some fundraising events in the \$10,000 to \$12,000 range. Your ideas and help will be greatly appreciated.

The projects include both immediate needs relating to building appearance, preservation and site grading as well as longer-term goals to meet requirements of the ADA and Labor & Industry. We

will be meeting quite frequently throughout the summer with our architect, Michael Gohl, as we try to prioritize our work and establish our 1 year, 5 year and long-term goals. We know there are certain things that need to be done to meet requirements and our first and biggest goal is to address these things in the proper sequence. We don't want to haphazardly accomplish one task only to realize months down the road that it doesn't really fit in with future plans and/or other needed changes.

Our immediate projects include: 1) site grading; 2) painting; 3) planting a couple of "antique" gardens in front of the building; 4) installing roof gutters; 5) a windows workshop on August 4th and 5th to repair and paint as many of the windows as we can. (mark your calendars); and 6) minor repairs to the roof and some trim boards to ready the building for painting.

Other projects include: 1) updating internal wiring; 2) addressing safety issues; 3) installing handicapped accessible entrance and restroom; 4) an additional stairway from the top floor; 5) a fire-rated wall between the furnace and the downstairs meeting room

Other long term issues will be discussed in depth with our architect and the Board of Directors.

The key issue that drives all others is: What do we want from our Historical Society? Please share your thoughts and your visions. They will all be helpful as we try to plan for the future, to best utilize our building for the benefit of the Historical Society and our town.

—Doug Porter & Bill Putnam

Cemetery Committee Report

Last year, most of the inscriptions were done for all the cemeteries in town. There is one section of the Mt. View Cemetery left to inscribe, plus the Smiley Cemetery in back of Bruce Miller's barn, the East Cambridge Cemetery by the old Nye farm, the Page Burial Plot on the Waterville Road and the Giddings Cemetery by Dana Sweet's house still need to be done. Volunteers would be greatly appreciated.

The next step will be to get all the information entered into a computer database so that we can have both a printed and digital form of storage and retrieval and be able to access all the town burials for any historical/genealogical searches.

Jennifer Bartlou has generously offered to help with entering the data into the computer database. When all inscriptions are entered, they will all be in the same format/program with as much information as can be feasibly entered.

This will be a great accomplishment for both the Historical Society and the town. The challenge now will be to keep current with new burials in town so that the database will be continually up to date with the latest information.

Our sincere thanks and appreciation to Malcolm Bevins for getting this project started and energizing the necessary volunteers to help bring the project to completion. His vision, knowledge and inspiration have been greatly appreciated by the Historical Society.

—Bill Putnam

Exhibition 2001

Despite a particularly hard winter here in northern Vermont, CHS proudly put on another amazing exhibition on January 27th and 28th. Volunteers, spruced up the hall and carted in enough antiques and working tools to put on a "hands on" exhibit which included live music played on a pump organ manufactured right here in Vermont.

There was also butter making, ice cream making, apple peeling and dehydrating, corn shelling, wool carding and spinning, quilting and on a 21st century note, video tapes of times gone by for folks to watch.

The refreshment committee had plenty of sweets for everyone to enjoy while watching the slide shows put on by Stub Wells and Bill Sanders.

The photograph committee put up a wonderful display of photos of early Cambridge. These photos have now been reproduced and cataloged.

The anteroom was enriched by the donated replicas of the Methodist Church, Cambridge Boro Graded School and Congregational Church, all of which burned to the ground at different times in Cambridge Village.

The Masons manned the top floor, answering questions from visitors about their order.

The Varnum Library put up a display and sold copies of "The History of Cambridge" by Winona Noble.

The Vermont Covered Bridge Society also had a display for folks interested in covered bridges.

THANKS to everyone who made it possible to give the "hands on" demonstrations during the following week for the Cambridge Elementary School children. The school was studying how people lived in Cambridge during the period of 1850-1870. The children enjoyed it very much and learned a lot about the life and times of early Vermonters. As a result of our exhibition, some of our members were invited to the school to show slides, talk about the history of early Cambridge and demonstrate early American decoration techniques.

THANKS TO ALL FOR YOUR HELP!

—Martha Kinney

Save Your Family History Part I

- Search out and sort family treasures: Old letters, Diaries, Period clothing, Photos, Implements, etc. Photograph large items like farm equipment
- Label art and photos *only* with a #2 pencil, on back
- Send for frames, but use professional framers to put photos, art etc. into chemical-free mats and backing (conservation materials)
- Do not use any chemicals or soaps on oil paintings; use only *soft bread* squeezed into small balls, and move gently across surface. Use a professional for more extensive cleaning
- Use natural waxes to polish furniture; aerosol sprays can slowly *eat* surfaces
- Good resources are ready to help protect your collection

Gaylord Company

has boxes, album pages, envelopes, etc. for every need

Customer Service 800/634-6307

Art Restorer

Rick Lapham, Shoreham VT

Framing Materials of Every Kind

Graphics Co. Graphik Dimensions

Customer Service, Catalog 800/221-0262

References

Shelburne Museum Staff

Gaylord Company

Fleming Museum Staff

??Questions??

Carol Bacon, Society "Historian" 644-5065

—Carol Bacon



A Fond Farewell

Malcolm and Sally Bevins moved to Cambridge from Shelburne, Vt., in 1981 amid rumors of a helicopter landing pad being built on their front lawn which, it turned out, were the beds for all the wonderful herbs Sally has raised over the past 20 years.

Sally owned and operated the Cambridge Herbary and also did an extensive circuit of craft shows over a period of 17 years.



Malcolm was a professor at UVM for 37 years and retired in 1993. He wanted to pursue his interest in history and genealogical research was the field in which he was most interested. He worked for the Vt. Council on the Humanities and he and Sally gave talks in 36 Vermont towns over the past 2 years.

When the Cambridge Historical Society was reformed, Malcolm became the chairman of the Research and Publications Committee and the Cemetery Committee. He completed a wonderful display for our exhibitions of folks who have lived in Cambridge from the 1700s on up. He also wrote indexes to Winona Noble's book "The History of Cambridge" for people and places mentioned in the book. He linked the Cambridge Historical Society website to the genealogical website on the internet.

Malcolm and his Cemetery Committee have been doing a super job mapping the various cemeteries in town.

Malcolm and Sally will be moving to Asheville, NC and will be missed by all. They promised to keep in touch by e-mail. Good luck with the next phase of your retirement. Asheville's gain will be our loss.

—Martha Kinney

A Birthday Tribute

A wise man said it best:
"Wherever I go, there I am."

This accurately describes one of our Honorary Board Members who will be celebrating his 89th birthday on June 21st. Who else but
.Wendell "Stub" Wells.

Many of us can relate bits and pieces of Cambridge history on an especially good day, but Stub not only does this *anytime*, but can also follow it up with a photo or a slide — to prove he knows what he is talking about!

Stub obtained his Uncle Harold Thomas' collection of photos and it didn't take long for others to realize, that by entrusting their photos to Stub they would be preserving them for the enjoyment of future generations. I might add that Stub is also a photographer in his own right!

Happy birthday Friend

—Roberta Marsh



Coming Attractions

❖ VERMONT HISTORY EXPO ❖

- ❖ 98 Historical Societies
- "Tell a Story" about their community
- ❖ 27 Related Museums will exhibit traditional crafts, antique farm equipment, etc.
- ❖ Authors and their books
- ❖ Resource People/Conservation Companies
- ❖ "Vermontiana"
- ❖ 24 Performers
- ❖ Food

When:

Saturday, June 23 and Sunday, June 24
10:00 am - 5:00 pm

Where:

Tunbridge World's Fair Grounds
Tunbridge, Vermont

VERMONT HISTORICAL SOCIETY

through October 31st
Baseball in Vermont

The Society Library is also available for research -
call ahead for hours

JULY 4TH CELEBRATION

Cambridge Historical Society's
Sugar on Snow Booth
(The snow is already stored and waiting)

Coming Meetings

*June Meeting A History of Cloverdale
 by Harold Putnam*

Audiotaping of members' stories

Films: "The Fifties";

"New England Memories", and more

Slides: "The Great Flood" and many more

Speakers from here and away

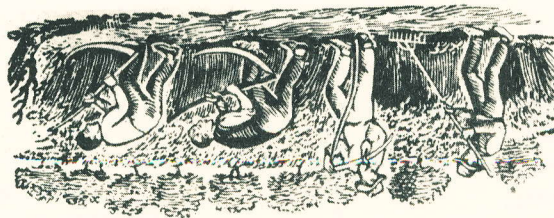
Shared meetings with other societies



We all recognize the time of year—but does anyone recognize the people?

—Photo supplied by Linda Ward

Cambridge Historical Society
Warner Lodge Building
School Street
Jeffersonville, VT 05464



Meetings are held the 2nd Wednesday of the month at 7:00 pm
Warner Lodge Building, School Street, Jeffersonville.
We hope to see you at the next meeting.

The societies web page has been maintained by Malcolm Bevins (see inside). The mantle has been passed to Ronnie Little, who is in the process of developing and expanding the site. When the new web site is accessible, we'll let you know. Meanwhile, if you would like to receive this newsletter electronically (in Acrobat .pdf format) or wish to receive announcements via e-mail, please send your e-mail address to gmlittle@sover.net.

This is the first of what we hope will be a quarterly newsletter. Contributions from members of the society and the greater community will make this effort both worthwhile and entertaining. Any contributions that you can make—photographs, anecdotes, essays, notices, etc.—will be gratefully accepted. This is our first issue, so expect glitches. We would welcome any comments (and graciously listen to any complaints) concerning the layout or content of this newsletter.

Contributions and/or comments can be made to any Officer or Board Member.